

Information Security Policy

Syed Motors · Document Code: POL-04 · Type: info_security · Department: All Employees

Purpose

This policy establishes rules for protecting Syed Motors information assets, including company laptops, DMS logins and customer records, against unauthorised access, loss or theft.

Information security is a company-wide responsibility. Employees may encounter company systems and information as part of sales, service, finance, HR, administration and other duties. The controls in this policy apply to employees handling those systems and assets.

The policy is effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. It is reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. Passwords and MFA

All company system passwords must be at least 12 characters with mixed case, digits and one symbol. Passwords rotate every 90 days and cannot be reused in the last five cycles.

Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for the DMS, email, and finance systems. Sharing credentials is a terminable offence.

Account protection

Employees should treat credentials as individual access information. A password should not be disclosed to another employee, written where unauthorised people can access it, or reused in a manner that defeats the company's stated password controls.

MFA provides an additional authentication step for the systems specifically identified in this policy. Employees should complete the MFA process through the approved company mechanism rather than bypassing it.

Information Security Policy — Authentication and Phishing

1. Passwords and MFA

Password lifecycle

The password requirement is a minimum of 12 characters and requires mixed case, digits and one symbol. Passwords rotate every 90 days and the last five password cycles cannot be reused.

Employees should plan for password changes before the existing password reaches its rotation point. A password change should be performed through the authorised company system rather than through an unsolicited reset link or message.

The policy treats credential sharing as a serious security violation. Employees must use their own account and must not allow another person to use their credentials, even when the other person is attempting to complete a work task.

MFA-protected systems

MFA is mandatory for the DMS, email and finance systems. Employees should not disable, bypass or work around the MFA requirement. If authentication fails unexpectedly, the employee should use the approved IT support process.

2. Phishing

Suspicious emails claiming to be from the OEM, banks, HR, or the branch manager, especially messages asking for a password reset or wire transfer, must be forwarded to security@sarmadmotors.pk immediately.

No employee will ever receive a legitimate email asking them to hand over their password.

Recognising suspicious requests

Employees should treat unexpected password-reset requests, urgent payment instructions, and messages that appear to imitate senior personnel as security-sensitive. The policy specifically identifies OEM, bank, HR and branch manager impersonation as examples.

The correct response to a suspicious message is to forward it to the stated security address immediately rather than replying to the sender or following the requested instruction.

Password requests

A legitimate email will not ask an employee to hand over their password. Employees should therefore never send their password in response to an email request, regardless of the sender name displayed in the message.

Information Security Policy — Device Handling

3. Device Handling

Company laptops must be locked when left unattended and must use full-disk encryption. Loss or theft must be reported within four hours to IT.

Personal USB drives may not be plugged into any company workstation. Bringing personal laptops onto the branch network is prohibited.

Laptop security

Employees should lock a company laptop whenever leaving it unattended, even for a short period. The lock requirement protects the active session from unauthorised access while the device is physically present in the workplace or another permitted location.

Full-disk encryption is a required protection for company laptops. Employees should not disable security controls or attempt to replace them with personal security software without an authorised company process.

Lost or stolen equipment

A lost or stolen company laptop or other relevant device must be reported to IT within four hours. Employees should not delay reporting while trying to locate the device themselves, because early reporting allows the company to begin the appropriate security response.

When reporting a loss or theft, the employee should provide the information requested by IT so that the affected asset and account access can be identified.

Removable media

Personal USB drives are prohibited on company workstations. Employees should use only company-approved methods for transferring or storing work information. A personal USB device should not be connected simply because it is convenient for moving files.

Personal laptops

Personal laptops may not be brought onto the branch network. Employees should use company-approved devices and network access arrangements for company work.

Information Security Policy — Incidents and Remote Access

4. Incident Reporting

Any suspected data breach, malware infection, or lost device must be reported to the IT Security Officer immediately.

Reporting in good faith is protected under the whistleblower clause of the HR policy. Failing to report is a disciplinary offence.

What should be reported

Examples covered by this requirement include suspected unauthorised exposure of company information, signs of malware infection, and loss of a company device. Employees do not need to establish the technical cause before reporting a suspicion.

The purpose of immediate reporting is to allow the responsible security personnel to assess the situation and take the appropriate response. Employees should avoid delaying a report while attempting to investigate the incident themselves.

Good-faith reporting

The policy protects good-faith reporting under the whistleblower clause of the HR policy. Employees should use the reporting requirement when they reasonably suspect a security issue rather than remaining silent because they are uncertain about its severity.

5. Remote Access

Remote access to any company system is only allowed through the corporate VPN with MFA. Public Wi-Fi, including airport and cafe networks, may not be used for DMS access even through VPN.

Remote access controls

Employees working remotely should establish the corporate VPN connection and complete MFA before accessing a company system. Remote access outside this approved method is not permitted by the policy.

The public Wi-Fi rule is especially specific for the DMS: airport and cafe Wi-Fi may not be used for DMS access even when the employee is connected through VPN. Employees should therefore use an allowed network arrangement when DMS access is required.

Remote working responsibility

Remote work does not remove the employee's responsibility to protect company systems. Employees should keep company devices under their control, follow the VPN and MFA requirements, and report a lost device or suspected security incident immediately.

Information Security Policy — Employee Responsibilities and Control

Employee Responsibilities

Every employee is responsible for following the security controls that apply to their use of company systems and devices. This includes protecting credentials, completing required MFA, recognising suspicious messages, protecting company laptops, reporting incidents, and using the approved remote-access method.

Security requirements should not be bypassed for convenience. If a legitimate business task cannot be completed because of an authentication, device, network or access issue, the employee should use the appropriate IT or security support channel.

Security response checklist

Credentials: maintain passwords meeting the stated 12-character complexity requirement, rotate them every 90 days, and do not reuse the last five cycles.

MFA: use MFA for DMS, email and finance systems.

Phishing: forward suspicious OEM, bank, HR or branch-manager messages, especially password-reset or wire-transfer requests, to security@sarmadmotors.pk immediately.

Devices: lock unattended company laptops, maintain full-disk encryption, report loss or theft to IT within four hours, and do not connect personal USB drives to company workstations.

Network: do not bring personal laptops onto the branch network. For remote access, use the corporate VPN with MFA; do not use public Wi-Fi for DMS access even through VPN.

Incidents: report suspected breaches, malware infections or lost devices to the IT Security Officer immediately.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the HR department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner.

Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual. The document owner is responsible for the annual review and revision of this controlled policy.

Key policy rules

Password: minimum 12 characters with mixed case, digits and one symbol; rotate every 90 days; no reuse of the last five cycles.

Credential sharing: prohibited and identified as a terminable offence.

Phishing: suspicious messages must be forwarded to the stated security address immediately; legitimate emails will never ask for a password.

Devices: company laptops must be locked when unattended and full-disk-encrypted; loss or theft must be reported to IT within four hours.

Removable media and personal devices: personal USB drives are prohibited on company workstations and personal laptops are prohibited from the branch network.

Remote access: company-system remote access requires corporate VPN with MFA; public Wi-Fi cannot be used for DMS access even through VPN.